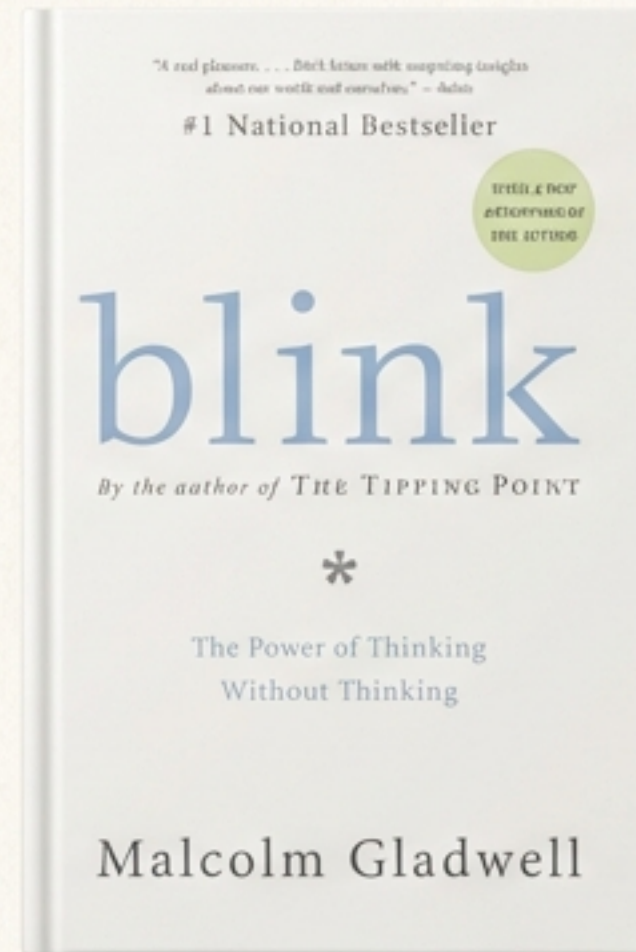


Blink: The Power of Thinking Without Thinking



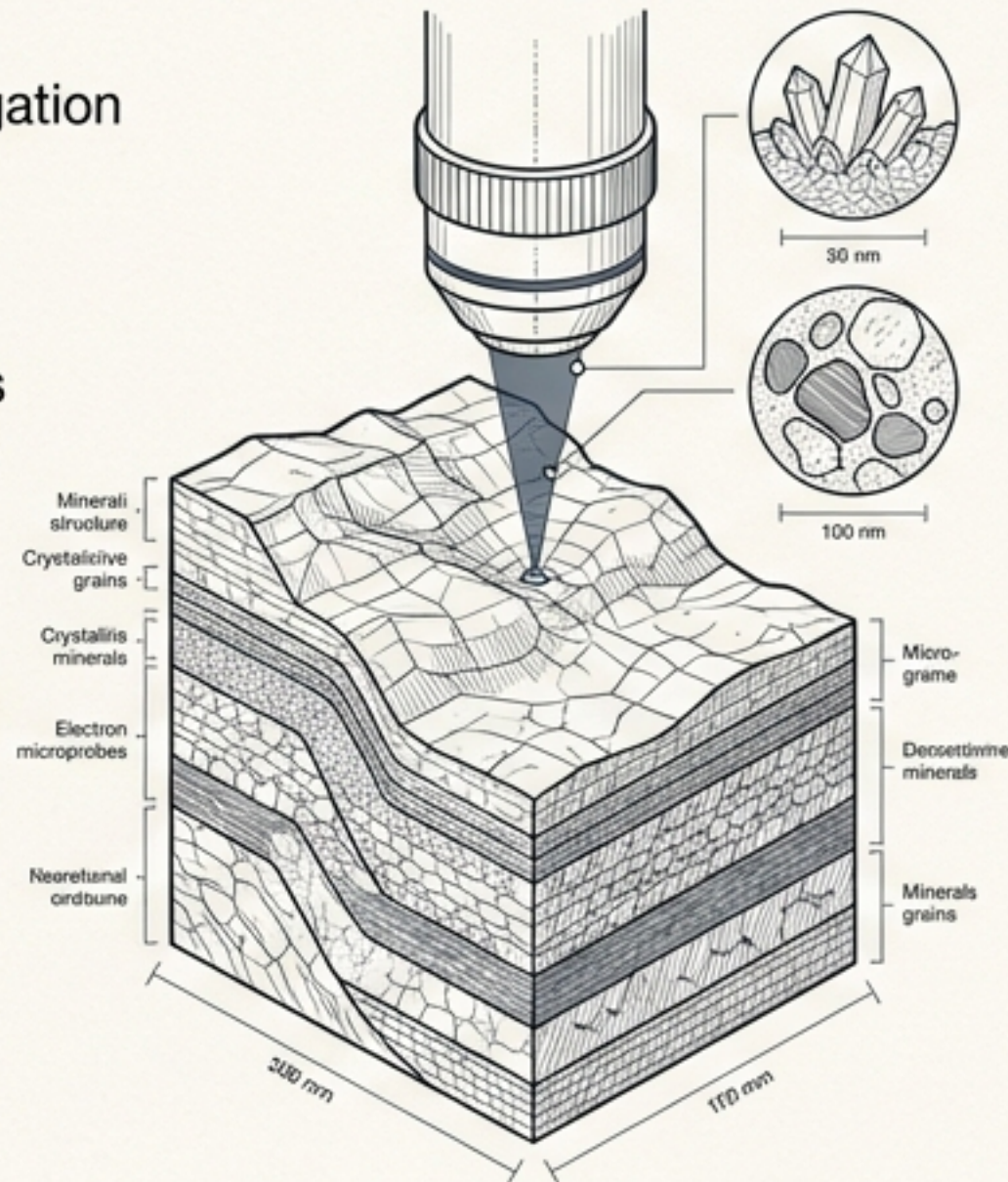
A Visual Case Study based on the work of Malcolm Gladwell

UNLOCKING THE MYSTERY OF THE ADAPTIVE UNCONSCIOUS

The 10 Million Dollar Mistake

The Science

- 14 Months of investigation
- High-resolution stereomicroscopy
- Electron microprobes
- X-ray diffraction
- **Conclusion:**
The dolomite marble is ancient.
The statue is **Real**.



The Instinct

- **Federico Zeri** (Historian):
Stared at the fingernails.
"Something is wrong."
- **Evelyn Harrison** (Expert):
"I'm sorry to hear you bought it."
- **Thomas Hoving** (Met Director):
One word: "Fresh."
- **Conclusion:**
In two seconds, they knew more than the scientists.
The statue is **Fake**.



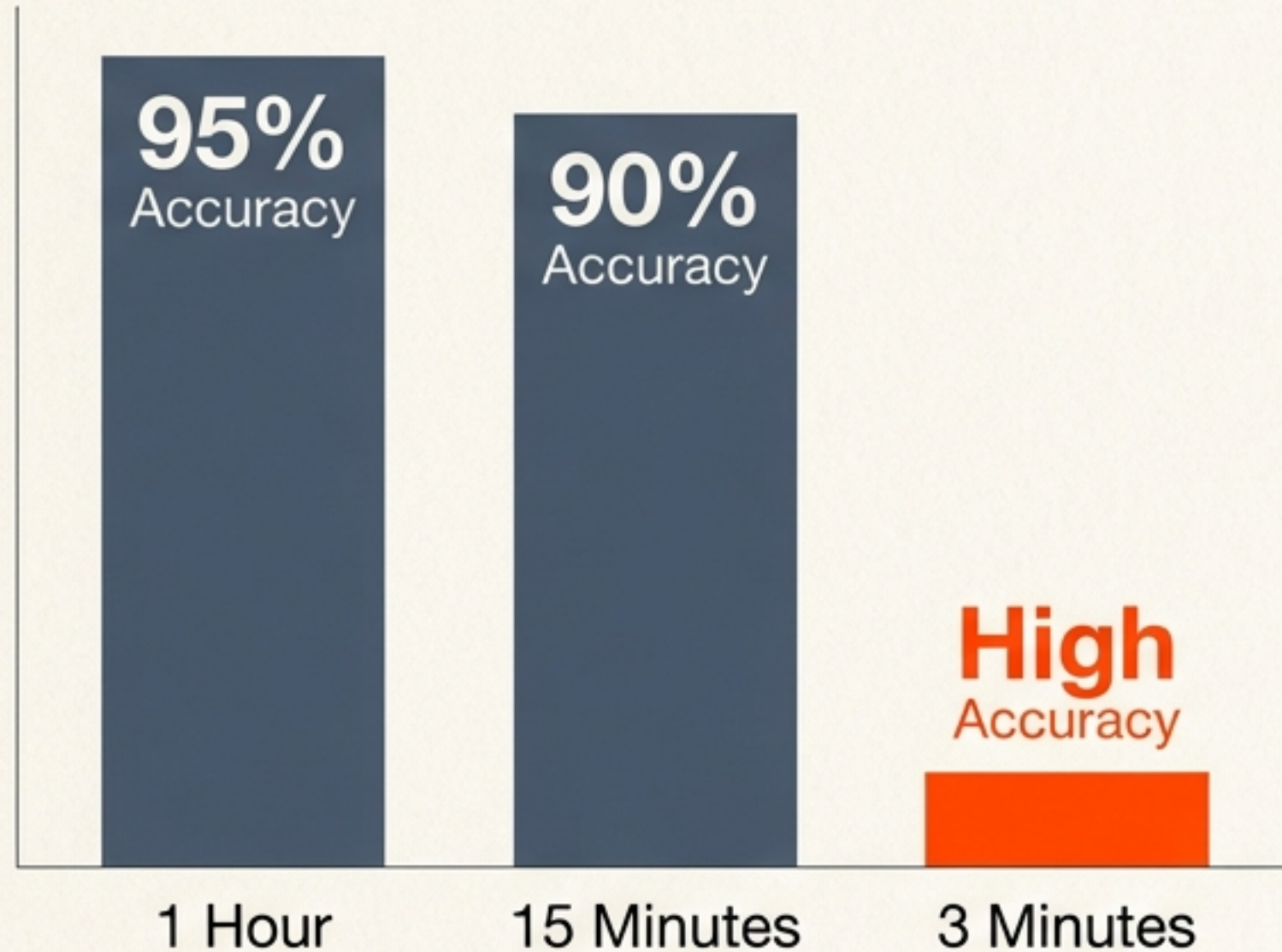
The Theory of Thin-Slicing

“Decisions made very quickly can be every bit as good as decisions made cautiously and deliberately.”

THIN-SLICING: The ability of our unconscious to find patterns in situations and behavior based on very narrow slices of experience. It is a survival mechanism—a giant computer that quickly processes data to keep us functioning.

The Mathematics of Divorce

Time Required to Predict Divorce



The Love Lab

John Gottman analyzes relationships using SPAFF (Specific Affect) coding. He doesn't look at the whole picture; he looks for a signature.

THE KEY INDICATOR: CONTEMPT

If one partner speaks from a superior plane, the marriage is in trouble.

Finding the “Fist”

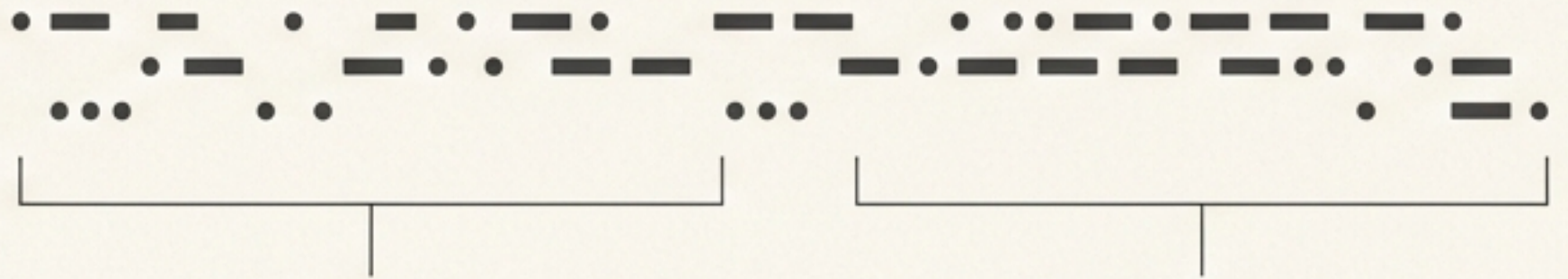


The Analogy of Morse Code

In WWII, British interceptors identified German operators not by the message, but by their “fist”—the unique rhythm of their dots and dashes.



Cadence



Rhythm

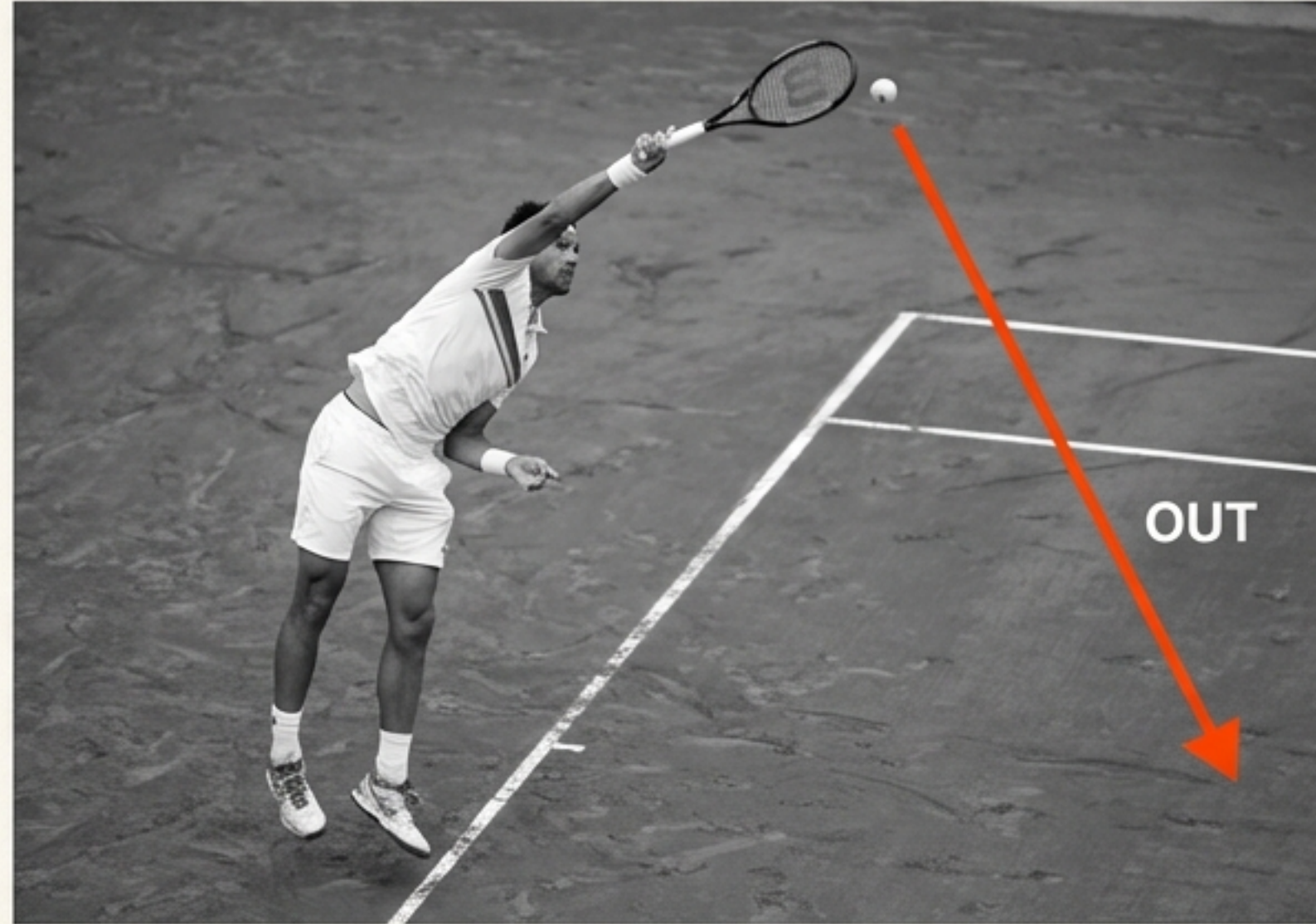
Signature

Relationships have a fist. To predict the future, you don't need years of history.
You need to identify the pattern in a “thin slice” of interaction.

The Locked Door

The Case of Vic Braden

Vic Braden could predict a double fault before the racket hit the ball. He correctly predicted **16 out of 17** double faults at Indian Wells.



“‘I was calling double faults on girls from Russia I’d never seen before in my life.’”

The Conflict: We can know something without **knowing WHY** we know it.
The mechanism is **locked behind the door of the unconscious.**

You Are Being Primed

Florida Gray
Wrinkle
Bingo



Subjects walked
significantly slower

Aggressively
Rude
Intrude



Subjects interrupted
in 5 minutes

Those primed with "Polite"
never interrupted at all.

Free will is partially an illusion. The adaptive unconscious acts as a mental valet, processing clues and altering behavior without awareness.

The Storytelling Problem

We have a storytelling problem. When asked to explain unconscious decisions, we **fabricate** rational explanations that are often completely **wrong**.



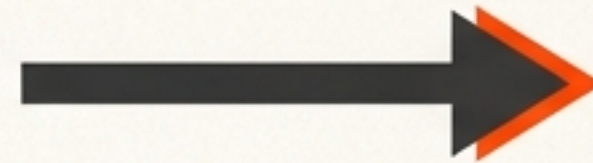
Stated Preference

I want someone
Sincere and Intelligent.



Actual Behavior

I chose someone
Attractive and **Funny**.

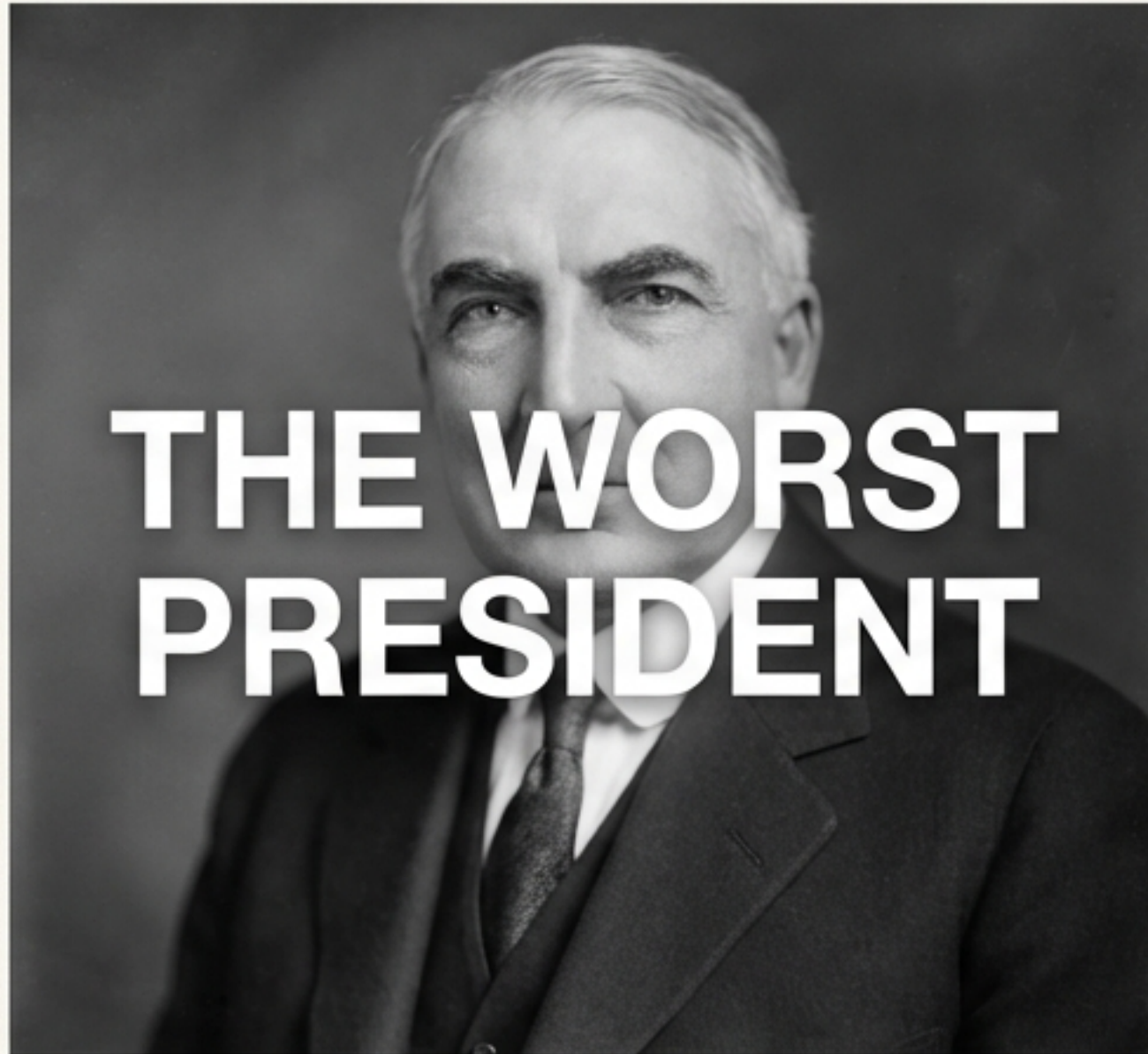


The Rationalization

I prefer funny people.
(The subject rewrites their history).

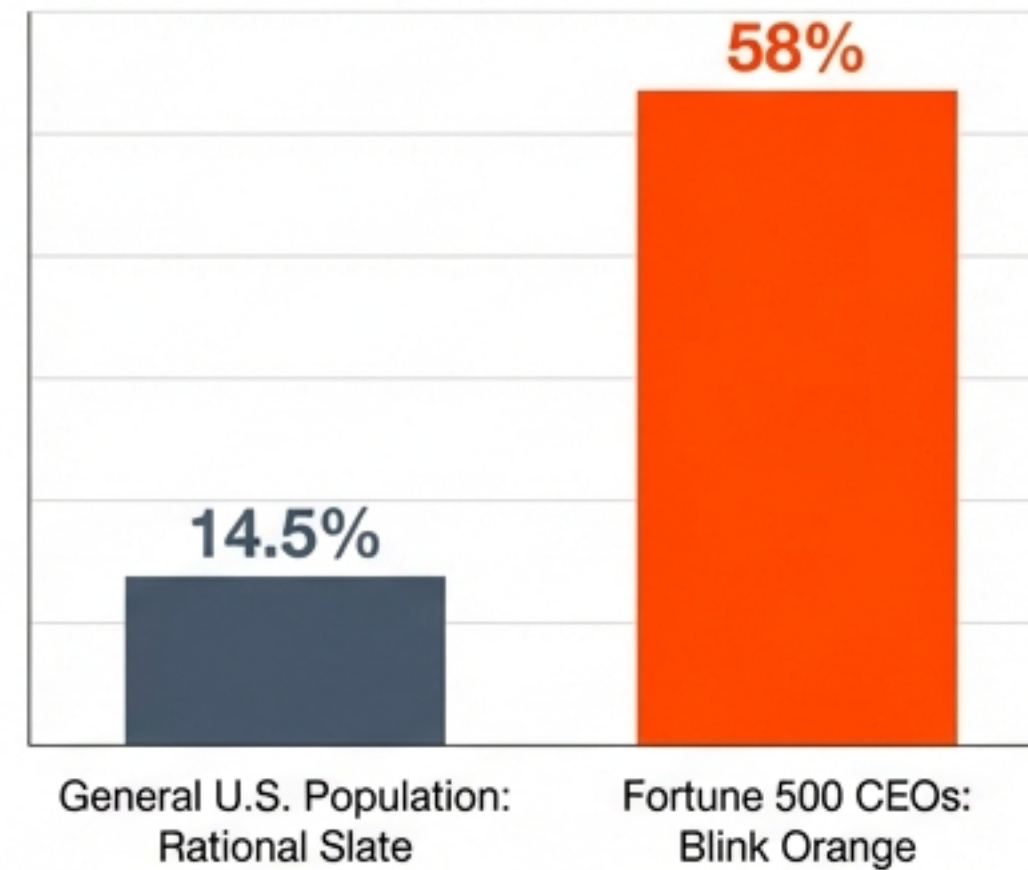
We construct narratives to make sense of actions driven by the unconscious mind, often obscuring the true drivers.

The Warren Harding Error



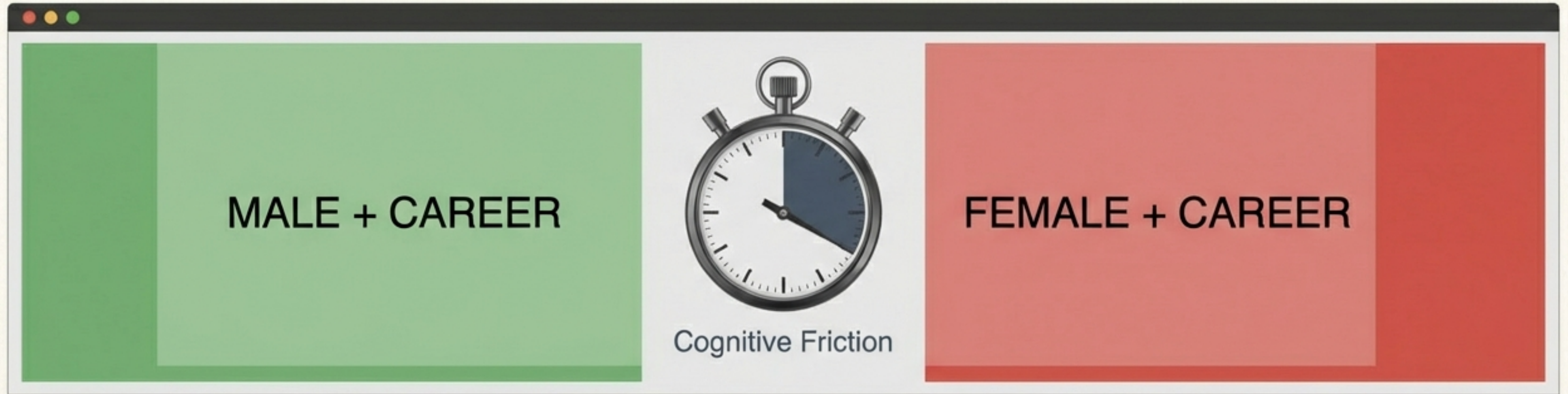
Height & Leadership

Percentage of men over 6 feet tall



We unconsciously equate height and appearance with leadership ability.
We judge the package, not the contents.

The Implicit Association Test (IAT)



It takes measurably longer for us to pair categories that contradict our cultural conditioning.

The Result: 80% of test-takers show a “pro-white” association.

This measures the “thumbprint of culture” on our unconscious, often conflicting with our stated values.

The Cost of the Blink



**Initial Offer Price
Above Invoice**
Ian Ayres Study

\$725



**Initial Offer Price
Above Invoice**
Ian Ayres Study

\$935



**Initial Offer Price
Above Invoice**
Ian Ayres Study

\$1,195



**Initial Offer Price
Above Invoice**
Ian Ayres Study

\$1,687

Bob Golomb, a master salesman, succeeds by fighting this error. He treats every customer the same, assuming everyone is a buyer. The average salesman prejudices, higher prices to minorities, and loses the sale.

Blue Team vs. Red Team

The Millennium Challenge
'02 War Game

THE ESTABLISHMENT

- Total Information Dominance
- Operational Net Assessment
- Matrixes & Databases
- Philosophy: Lift the fog of war with data.

THE ROGUE

- Paul Van Riper (Vietnam Vet)
- Motorcycle Couriers
- Light Signals
- Philosophy: Spontaneity and rapid cognition.

The Victory of Instinct



While Blue Team analyzed their matrixes, Red Team struck.
20,000 personnel casualty simulation.

The Lesson: "In the act of tearing something apart, you lose its meaning."
Blue Team drowned in data. Red Team used **rapid cognition**.

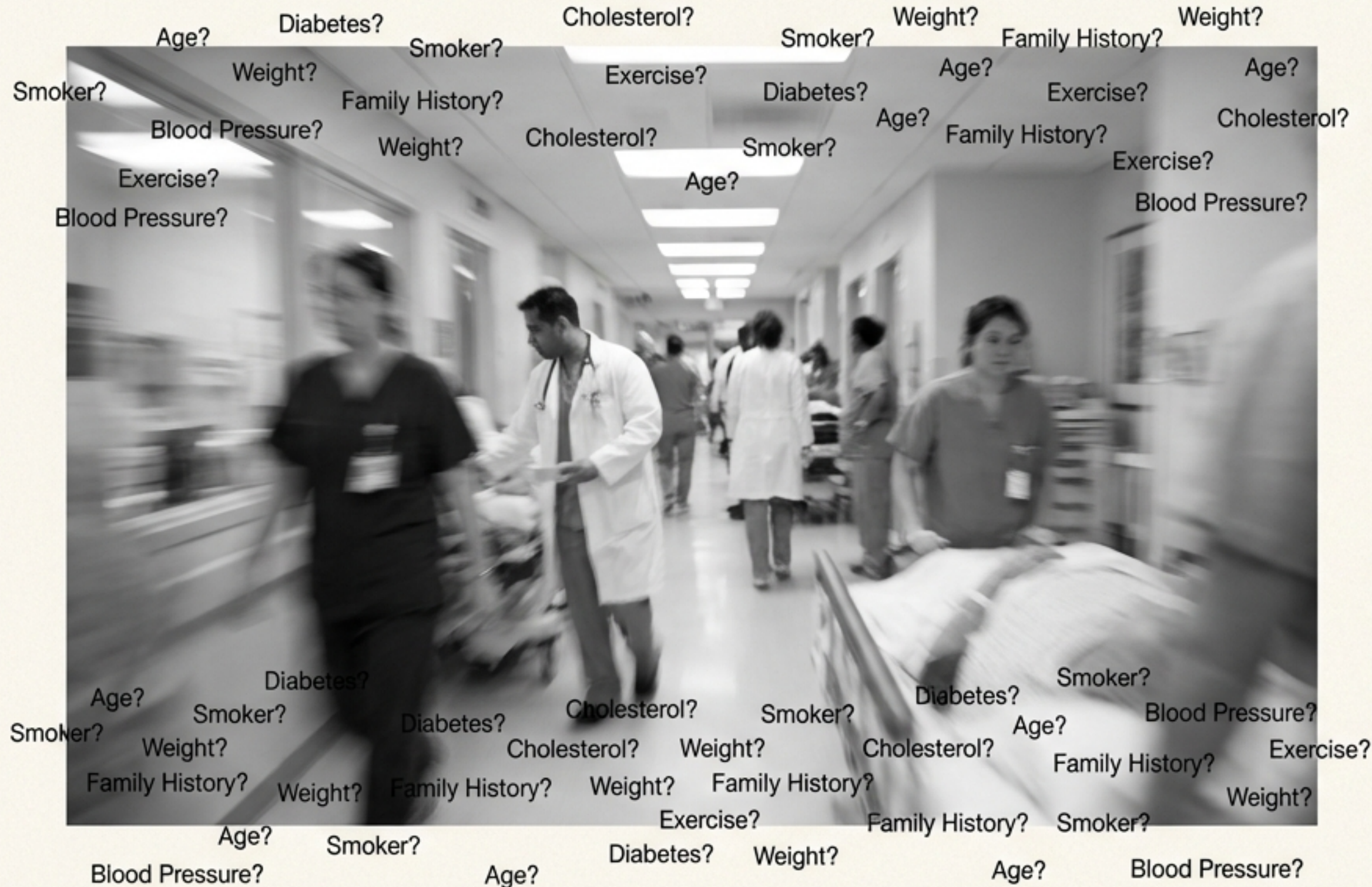
Creating Structure for Spontaneity



The Paradox: Spontaneity requires rules.

- **Improv Rule:** ‘Yes, And...’ (**Agreement**).
- **Military Rule:** Give the Intent, not the Method.
- By reducing rigid top-down structure, we allow field commanders—and actors—to **thin-slice** effectively.

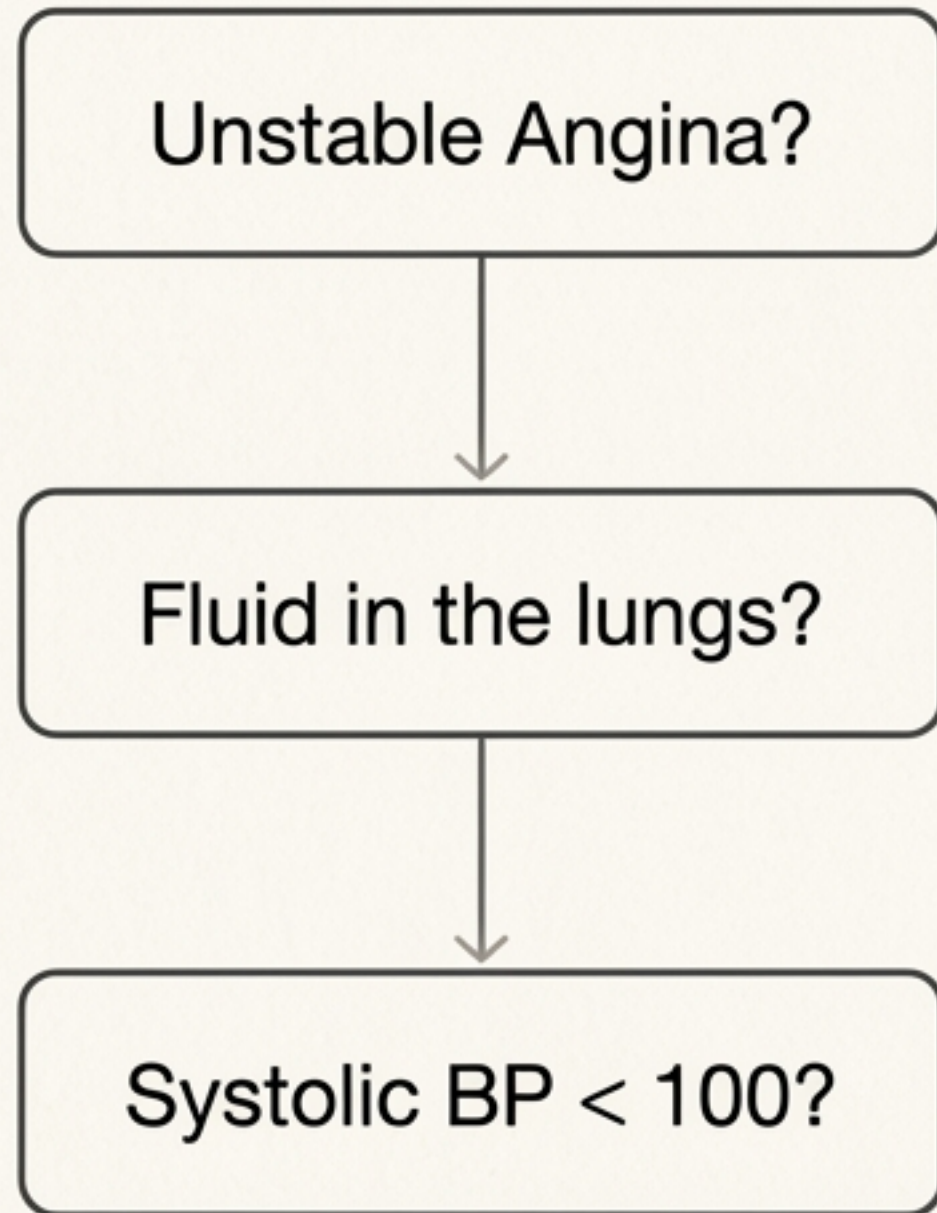
Crisis in the ER



The Problem: Cook County Hospital was overwhelmed. Doctors sought **MORE information** to feel confident about heart attack diagnoses.

The Trap: Extra information didn't help. It confused the diagnosis. Estimates ranged from **0% to 100%** for the same patients.

The Goldman Algorithm



The Solution: Edit the world.

By ignoring age, weight, and diabetes, the algorithm performed **70%** better than trained physicians.

Takeaway: Extra information is not just useless; it is harmful.

Kenna's Dilemma

THE EXPERTS

U2's Manager:
"He will change the world."

Fred Durst: "Sign him!"



THE RESEARCH

Market Research:
"Subdued."
"Lacks a core audience."

The Conflict: The experts (thin-slicing) loved him.
The public (forced to analyze) rejected him.

The Pepsi Challenge Flaw



The Sip Test

Rewards sweetness. Single dimension.



The Whole Experience

Rewards body. Sensation Transference
(Brand + Can + Taste).

Why New Coke failed: The taste test stripped away the context required to make a true judgment. A sip is not a 'thick slice' of the experience.

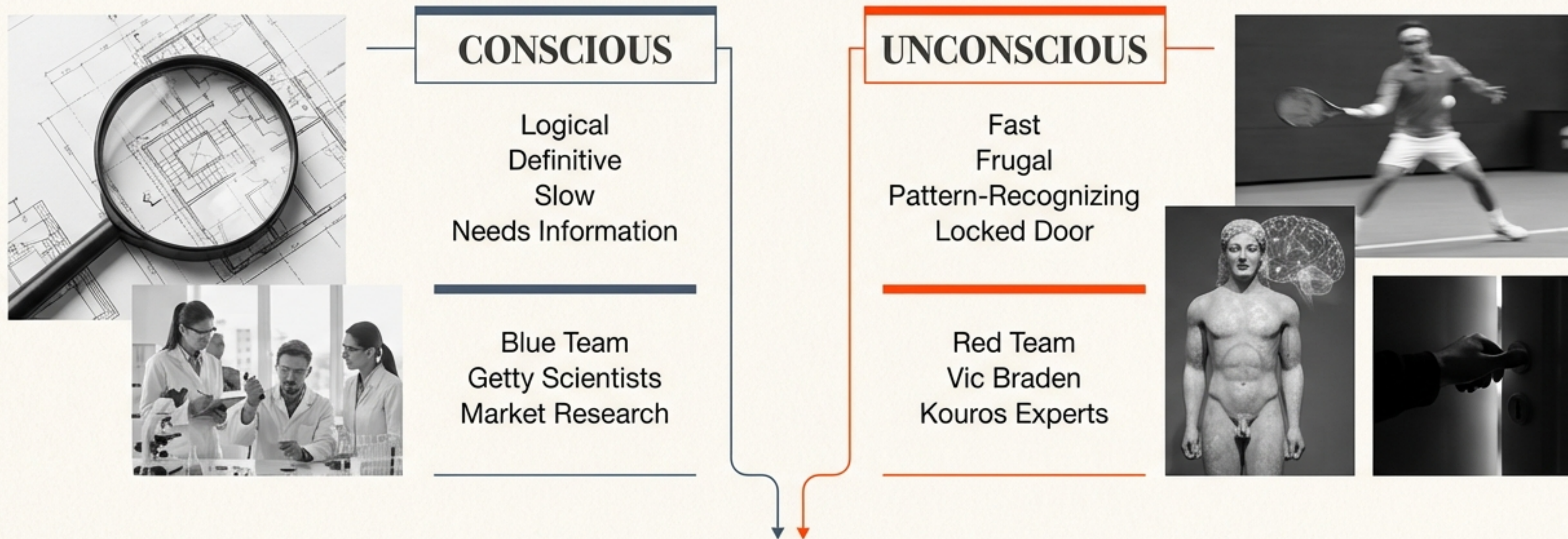
The Fragility of Insight



Asking people to explain WHY they like something destroys their ability to know WHAT they like.

Insight is a flickering candle. It can be easily extinguished by the demand for rationalization.

Two Minds



The Goal: To know when to trust the blink (expert patterns)
and when to distrust it (bias and error)

Listening with Your Eyes



“ The task of making sense of ourselves requires that we acknowledge there can be as much value in the blink of an eye as in months of rational analysis.